



NCCER Module 22101



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Orientation to the Trade





Section Two

Responsibilities and Characteristics of Operators

Objective

2. Explain the responsibilities and characteristics required of heavy equipment operators.
 - a. Describe employee responsibilities.
 - b. Explain the importance of human relations.
 - c. Explain the importance of safety in the operation of heavy equipment.



Performance Tasks

Under the supervision of an instructor, trainees should be able to do the following:

There are no Performance Tasks associated with this section.



2.0.0 Responsibilities and Characteristics of Operators

To be successful, professionals must be able to:

- Use current trade materials, tools, and equipment.
- Perform tasks quickly and efficiently.
- Adapt to changing situations.
- Stay current on technical advancements and skills.
- Prioritize safety.



2.1.0 Employee Responsibilities

All employees must:

- Do assigned work.
- Follow company policies and procedures.
- Do what is asked by supervisors.
- Work well with others.
- Accept responsibility for their actions.



2.1.1 Professionalism

- Professionalism is the overall behavior and attitude expected in the workplace.
- Professionalism includes honesty, productivity, safety, civility, cooperation, teamwork, clear and concise communication, being on time and prepared for work, and regard for one's impact on one's co-workers.



2.1.2 *Honesty*

Honesty means:

- Giving a fair day's work for a fair day's pay
- Your actions match your words
- Your words are factual
- Not taking items from the job site unless authorized



2.1.3 Loyalty

Employers expect employees to do the following:

- Keep company interests in mind.
- Speak well of the company to others.
- Keep minor troubles strictly within the plant or office.
- Keep business matters confidential.



2.1.4 Willingness to Learn

- Every job has its own way of doing things, so be prepared to adapt and learn.
- Changes in safety regulations or technology require retraining.



2.1.5 Willingness to Take Responsibility

- Be proactive! See what needs to be done, then do it.
- Do what your supervisor asks the first time.
- Everyone is responsible for safety.



2.1.6 Willingness to Cooperate

Teamwork is essential to maintaining a safe, respectful, and productive work environment.



2.1.7 Rules and Regulations

- An employee must be familiar with the company policies and procedures, especially with regard to safety practices.
- When OSHA inspectors visit a job site, they often question employees and crew leaders about the company policies related to safety.



2.1.8 Tardiness and Absenteeism

- Being late or absent often is considered unprofessional. There may be penalties associated with poor attendance.
- Missing work can also delay your team from starting work, which can delay the larger project.
- If you must miss work for a legitimate reason, make sure to contact the appropriate people before the work day begins so that they can find a replacement.



2.2.0 The Importance of Human Relations

Good human relations includes being friendly, pleasant, courteous, cooperative, adaptable, and sociable.



2.2.1 Making Human Relations Work

Important aspects of human relations:

- Knowing how to handle difficult situations
- Working with demanding supervisors or difficult coworkers
- Building good working relationships



2.2.2 Human Relations and Productivity

- Working well with others increases productivity.
- Everyone must do their part.
- Keep in mind that you are building professional relationships and your own reputation in addition to performing your job well.



2.2.3 The Importance of a Positive Attitude

- A positive attitude is important for safety and productivity.
- Positivity also helps build good professional relationships.



2.3.0 The Importance of Safety

SAFETY IS EVERYONE'S RESPONSIBILITY.

- Follow regulations from your employer and OSHA.
- Report unsafe conditions immediately to a supervisor.



2.3.1 OSHA (1 of 2)

OSHA is responsible for:

- Setting and enforcing occupational safety and health standards on the job site.
- Making sure that employers provide and maintain a safe workplace for all employees.
- Providing research and educational programs to support safe working practices.



2.3.1 OSHA (2 of 2)

- OSHA will periodically inspect job sites.
- OSHA requires employers to give their employees on-the-job safety training.
- All personnel on a job site must comply with OSHA regulations.



2.3.2 MSHA

- MSHA guidelines also apply to job sites with mining activity.
- Additional training should be provided if you work on these job sites.



2.3.3 General Safety Requirements

- Regular inspections and maintenance
- Proper use according to the rating or capacity of the equipment
- Knowing and understanding specific safety procedures and precautions
- Operating equipment according to manufacturer's guidelines



Wrap Up – Trade Terms

Mine Safety and Health Administration (MSHA): A federal government agency established to ensure the safety of mining operations.

Occupational Safety and Health Administration (OSHA): The federal government agency established to ensure a safe and healthy environment in the workplace.

Integrity: Soundness of character or commitment to moral and ethical principles.

Procedures: Instructions on how to carry out a policy.

Productivity: The rate at which work is accomplished.



2.0.0 Section Review Question 1

1. The term that defines a person achieving the desired overall behavior and attitude expected in the workplace is _____.
 - a. loyalty
 - b. honesty
 - c. professionalism
 - d. attitude



2.0.0 Section Review Question 1 Answer

1. The term that defines a person achieving the desired overall behavior and attitude expected in the workplace is _____.
 - a. loyalty
 - b. honesty
 - c. professionalism**
 - d. attitude



2.0.0 Section Review Question 2

2. Which of the following characteristics is an aspect of human relations?
- a. Wearing the required PPE
 - b. Willingness to learn
 - c. Willingness to take responsibility
 - d. Maintaining a positive attitude



2.0.0 Section Review Question 2 Answer

2. Which of the following characteristics is an aspect of human relations?
- a. Wearing the required PPE
 - b. Willingness to learn
 - c. Willingness to take responsibility
 - d. Maintaining a positive attitude**



2.0.0 Section Review Question 3

3. Which of the following statements describes the mission of OSHA?
- a. Inspect job sites and punish offenders.
 - b. Set and enforce occupational safety and health standards for all places of employment.
 - c. Ensure that all workers are wearing the required PPE.
 - d. Advise Congress on construction health and safety.



2.0.0 Section Review Question 3 Answer

3. Which of the following statements describes the mission of OSHA?
- a. Inspect job sites and punish offenders.
 - b. Set and enforce occupational safety and health standards for all places of employment.**
 - c. Ensure that all workers are wearing the required PPE.
 - d. Advise Congress on construction health and safety.



Next...



Review and Module Examination

Complete the Review Questions at the end of the module and prepare for the Module Exam.